

Introduction to Paid Social Media

Module 10 — By the end of this module, you will understand the difference between organic and paid social, how Meta Ads work, how to define your audience and budget, why creative testing matters, and the key metrics every advertiser needs to know.

MODULE 10

BEGINNER-FRIENDLY



Organic vs. Paid Social Media

Businesses can reach people on social media in two fundamental ways. Understanding the difference helps you decide when to invest time and when to invest money.

Organic Social

Content published without directly paying the platform to distribute it as an ad. You **earn attention** through quality and consistency.

- Instagram Reels, carousels, Stories
- Facebook and LinkedIn posts
- YouTube videos

Paid Social

You **pay the platform** to distribute your message to a specifically selected audience — faster, and at scale.

- Targeted ads by location, interest, behavior
- Reach people who don't follow you yet
- Promote offers, drive traffic, generate leads

 Neither is automatically better. Organic builds trust and community over time. Paid accelerates reach and results. The strongest strategies combine both.



What Are Meta Ads?

Meta Ads are paid advertisements created through Meta's advertising system. They can appear across Meta's full ecosystem — **Facebook, Instagram, Messenger**, and other supported placements — reaching billions of people globally.

What Businesses Can Do

- Drive website purchases or traffic
- Build brand awareness in a new market
- Generate leads and appointment enquiries
- Re-engage people who visited their website

Boost vs. Campaign — Know the Difference

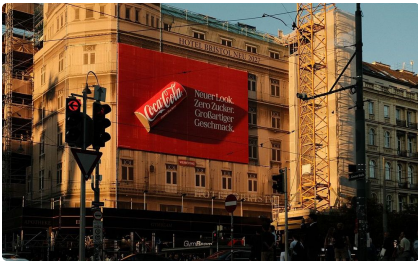
A **boosted post** is a simplified shortcut for promoting existing content. A **properly structured campaign** gives marketers far more control over:

- Objectives, audiences, and placements
- Budgets, creatives, and measurement

For serious results, learn the campaign structure — not just the boost button.

Campaign Objectives: Awareness, Traffic & Leads

One of the most common beginner mistakes is launching an ad without defining what you actually want it to achieve. Every campaign should start with a clear objective.



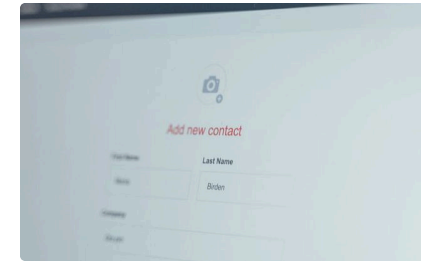
Awareness

Introduce your brand to more relevant people. Best for new businesses or new product launches. The key question: *How many people can we reach?*



Traffic

Send people to a website, landing page, app, or product page. Best when you want clicks and visits. The key question: *Can we get relevant people to our destination?*

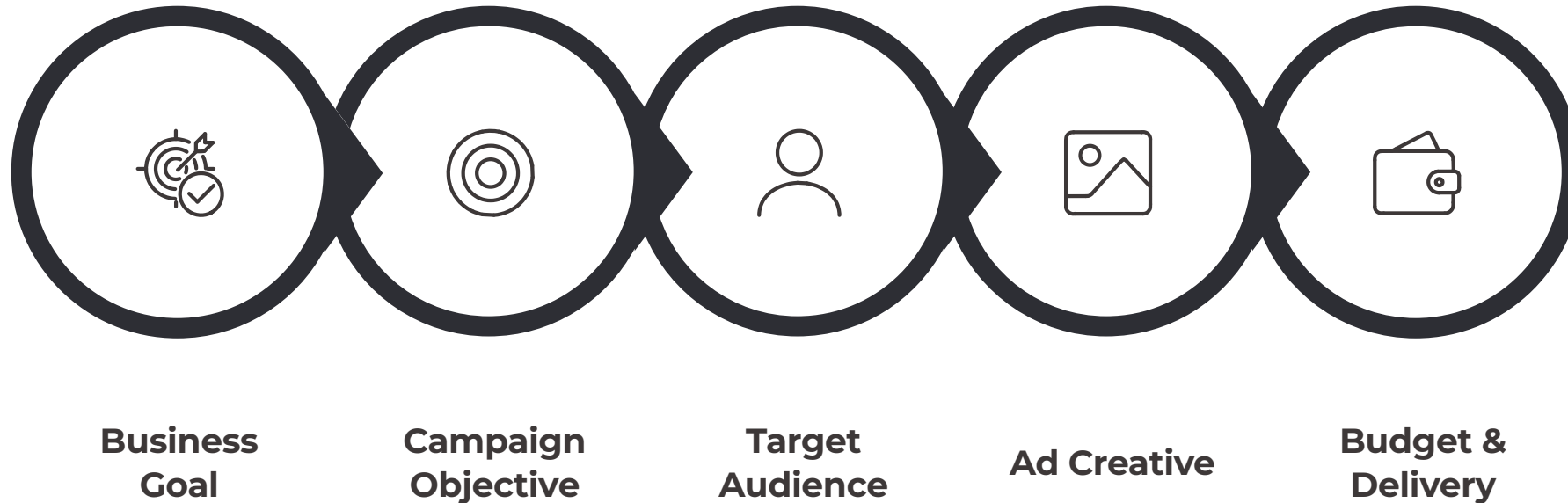


Leads

Generate enquiries — names, phone numbers, emails, or appointment requests. Best for service businesses. The key question: *Can we create genuine potential customers?*

How a Paid Campaign Actually Works

Every effective paid campaign follows a logical flow. Think of it as a chain — a weak link at any stage can compromise the entire result.



Real Example: GlowUp Salon, Thane

- **Goal:** Get new appointment enquiries
- **Objective:** Leads
- **Audience:** People near the salon interested in beauty

What the Marketer Measures

- **Creative:** Short Reel showing the service and offer
- **Budget:** ₹15,000 for the campaign period
- **Results:** Leads, cost per lead, reach, impressions

Understanding Your Target Audience

Paid advertising becomes powerful when you can define *exactly* who should see your ad. Modern platforms use a rich set of signals to find the right people.



Location & Demographics

Target by city, neighborhood, radius, age, and gender where relevant. A Thane salon likely doesn't need to advertise across all of India.



Interests & Behaviors

Reach people based on what they engage with — beauty, fitness, food, travel, and more. The platform tracks patterns to match intent.



Custom & Similar Audiences

Upload your existing customer list, retarget website visitors, or reach people who previously engaged with your content.

 **Beginner Rule:** Don't target everyone just because anyone could theoretically become a customer. A narrower, relevant audience often outperforms a massive irrelevant one — but don't go so narrow that the platform can't optimize.

Budget Basics & Creative Testing

Two Budget Approaches

Daily Budget: Set an approximate daily spend. Example: ₹500/day — the platform paces delivery across the day.

Lifetime Budget: Set a total for the full campaign period. Example: ₹15,000 over 30 days — the platform optimizes pacing automatically.

The right budget depends on your objective, audience size, competition, and how long the campaign runs. **Strategy first. Budget second.**

Why Creative Testing Matters

Creative testing means running different versions of your ad to learn what resonates. You can test:

- Different hooks or opening lines
- Different visuals or video formats
- Different offers or messaging angles
- Different CTAs or headlines

Example: Ad A: "3 skincare mistakes ruining your routine." Ad B: "Build a simple routine in 3 steps." Same product — different message. Let the data decide.

 A bigger budget does not automatically mean better results. If the audience is wrong, the creative is weak, or the offer is unclear — more spend only amplifies the problem.

Key Paid Advertising Terminology

Paid social has its own vocabulary. Knowing these terms helps you read reports, ask better questions, and make smarter decisions.

CPM

Cost Per 1,000 Impressions. Measures how efficiently your budget generates exposure. Useful for awareness campaigns.

CPC

Cost Per Click. Formula: $\text{Total Spend} \div \text{Clicks}$. Example: $\text{₹1,000} \div 200 \text{ clicks} = \text{₹5 CPC}$.

CTR

Click-Through Rate. Formula: $\text{Clicks} \div \text{Impressions} \times 100$. Example: 30 clicks from 1,000 impressions = **3% CTR**.

CPL

Cost Per Lead. Formula: $\text{Total Spend} \div \text{Leads}$. Example: $\text{₹5,000} \div 50 \text{ leads} = \text{₹100 CPL}$.

Also remember: **Reach** = unique people who saw your ad. **Impressions** = total times it was displayed (one person can generate multiple impressions). **Conversion** = the desired action completed (purchase, lead, booking). **CTA** = the instruction telling someone what to do next. **Landing Page** = where users go after clicking.

Common Paid Advertising Mistakes

Most beginner errors aren't about spending too little — they're about planning too little. Here are the mistakes that cost businesses money without generating results.

No Clear Objective

Running an ad without defining what you want is the most common — and most costly — mistake. Every campaign needs a goal before anything else.

Judging Results Too Early

Changing campaigns before they collect enough data prevents the platform from optimizing. Patience and sufficient data are required before drawing conclusions.

Weak or Mismatched Creative

Poor-quality visuals, cluttered text, or unclear offers lose attention immediately. The ad and landing page must tell the same story seamlessly.

Chasing Cheap Leads

A ₹50 lead that never converts is more expensive than a ₹150 lead that becomes a loyal customer. Always evaluate lead *quality*, not just lead *cost*.

Your Pre-Launch Checklist & Key Takeaways

Before launching any campaign, you should be able to answer every one of these questions. If you can't, the campaign needs more planning.



Goal

What exactly do we want the customer to do?



Audience

Who should see this ad, and where are they?



Offer

What are we offering, and is it compelling?



Creative

Will the audience understand the message quickly?



Budget

How much are we willing to spend, and for how long?



Measurement

How will we define whether this campaign worked?

 **THRM Beginner Tip:** Don't start with "How much should I spend?" Start with "What exactly do I want the customer to do?" Once the objective is clear, everything else — audience, creative, budget, and measurement — follows naturally from that answer.